

New probe of Harvard focuses on admissions

Follows ruling ending affirmative action

By Nick Stoico and Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration opened a new line of attack against Harvard University this week, disclosing that it is investigating whether the Cambridge school's admissions policies violate the Supreme Court's ruling that ended affirmative action.

The Department of Justice notified Harvard of the investigation in a letter, The New York Times reported Thursday, saying the inquiry was opened under the False Claims Act, which is a law designed to punish those who defraud the government.

The Justice Department said it had no comment to the Globe, which also requested a copy of the letter.

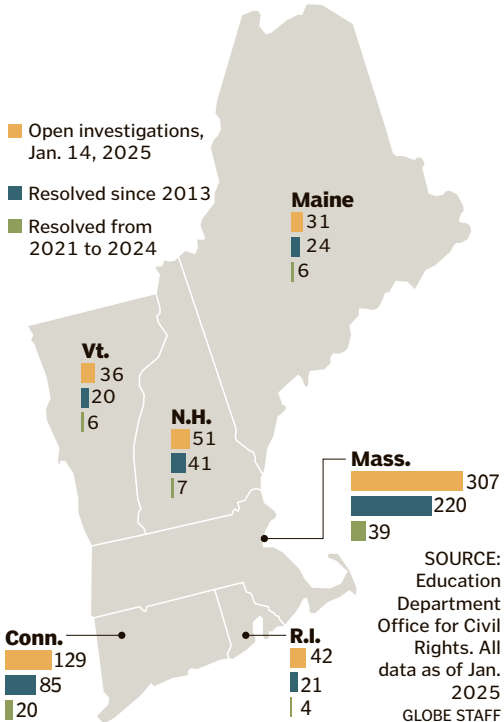
Jason Newton, a Harvard spokesperson, said in a statement to the Globe the university will "continue to defend its core, legally protected principles against unfounded retaliation by the federal government."

"This investigation is yet another abusive and retaliatory action — the latest of many —

HARVARD, Page A7

Nearly 600 open civil rights investigations across New England as of Jan. 2025

Federal databases on Office for Civil Rights investigations and resolutions have not been updated since Trump took office. Data from January show there were more open cases than had been resolved in the prior decade.



Families fear complaints of bias will be left behind

With civil rights offices closed, who will listen?

By Steph Machado and John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Two Black sisters say classmates repeatedly used racial slurs toward them at school. A new mom claims her disability accommodations were abruptly changed, causing her to fall behind in graduate school. A METCO student transferred out of his suburban high school after being called the n-word.

► A federal agreement that subjected Boston Public Schools to additional scrutiny over English learners is ending. B1.

These cases are among the 12,000 civil rights complaints that were pending at the US Department of Education when President Trump took office in January. They were filed by New England parents and students who said they were discriminated against on the basis of race, sex, and disability.

But after the Trump administration slashed the Education Department in half, closed civil rights offices, and shifted the agency's focus to

CIVIL RIGHTS, Page A7

Justices weigh courts' reach

Birthright hearing turns on whether one judge can halt Trump edict nationally

By Abbie VanSickle
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court wrestled on Thursday with the Trump administration's complaints that federal judges have exceeded their authority in temporarily blocking some of his policy moves for the whole country.

Several of the justices appeared torn between two concerns. They appeared skeptical that single district judges should have the power to freeze executive actions throughout the nation.

But they also seemed troubled by the legality — and consequences — of the executive order underlying the case: an order issued by President Trump on his first day in office ending

birthright citizenship, or the granting of automatic citizenship to all babies born in the United States.

Three lower federal judges have said Trump's order violated the 14th Amendment of the Constitution as well as longstanding precedent and blocked the policy across the country. In an unusual move, the justices had agreed to hear oral argument on whether the judges should have limited their rulings only to the states, advocacy groups, and individuals that had sued over the order.

The Trump administration had asked the justices to consider the legality of such injunctions, which have been a major impediment to Trump's agenda.

But the justices appeared to struggle with

how they might quickly weigh in on the legality of the order, which the administration had not asked them to review.

"This case is very different from a lot of our nationwide injunction cases in which many of us have expressed frustration at the way district courts are doing their business," Justice Elena Kagan said, appearing to articulate the view of several of the justices. She noted that such injunctions have been used to block policies under both Democratic and Republican administrations.

"In the first Trump administration, it was all done in San Francisco, and then in the next administration, it was all done in Texas, and there is a big problem that is created by that

BIRTHRIGHT, Page A6



DREW ANGERER/APF VIA GETTY IMAGES

A woman with her son protested outside the Supreme Court Thursday, as arguments on injunctions and citizenship were heard.

'It's not really a secret that a lot of us are feeling some fear.'

MEGHA VEMURI, MIT, class of 2025 president

A graduation season flavored with trepidation

Federal actions hang over celebrations

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

In 2020, COVID-19 led to the cancellation of in-person graduation ceremonies across the country. Last year, amid the Israel-Hamas war, many students disrupted the usual pomp and circumstance with chants for a "free, free Palestine" and mass walkouts.

The class of 2025 knows disappointment. It knows defiance. And now, four months into President Trump's second term, it knows trepidation and dread.

Massachusetts Institute of Technology's 2025 class president, Megha Vemuri, recently recalled the "ginormous, very powerful

walkout" over the war in Gaza at the school's 2024 commencement ceremony. But in the current climate, "I can't imagine people feeling comfortable to do something like the walkout now," she said.

Commencement is supposed to be a time of celebration, but this season is shaping up to be subdued. Spring is still spring — students are back on the quad reading, sunbathing, skateboarding, and playing spikeball. Trump's attacks on higher education haven't stopped the steady beat of a cappel-la concerts or end-of-year parties. Beer pong goes on.

"Seniors are just soaking up

COMMENCEMENTS, Page A10



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Megha Vemuri, MIT class president, said: "I think what my classmates really need to hear is that this fear is what needs to drive change."

Health care CEO accused of plagiarism

Blog entries appear to mimic other sources

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

and Maren Halpin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Soon after becoming chief executive of Western Massachusetts' biggest health system last June, Peter Banko began writing a weekly blog that delivers inspirational messages to Baystate Health's 13,000 employees.

Called "Connect," the blog appears in the company's internal network and offers observations on figures as diverse as Martin Luther King Jr., baseball great Pete Rose, and the late General Electric chief executive Jack Welch. It also dispenses lessons from business, sports, and Banko's own life, including the importance of telling the truth.

However, a Globe review of the CEO's blog found more than 20 posts containing passages that were identical or nearly identical to those in articles that appeared elsewhere. The sources included Forbes, Sports Illustrated, NPR, ESPN, Harvard Business Review, and other websites, according to the review.

The company posts in question appeared from July 1 of last year through as recently as May 12.

One post described growing

BANKO, Page A10

A baby with a rare genetic disorder is the first patient to be healed with a custom gene-editing treatment. A2.

A round of Ukraine peace talks in Turkey descended into bluster and confusion, as Ukrainian and Russian delegations arrived in different cities. A4.

Nearly one-third of lab space across the region is available for lease, either directly from a landlord or via sublease from an occupant that no longer needs it. B5.

Juan Francisco Méndez walked out of the Burlington ICE field office, one step closer to reuniting with his wife and 9-year-old son. B1.



Mist chance

Friday: Early fog, cloudy. High: 69-74. Low: 58-63.

Saturday: Cloudy, stormy. High: 66-71. Low: 58-63.

High tide: 2:06 a.m. 2:49 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:21 Sunset: 8

Comics and Weather, G6-7.

Obituaries, C9.

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